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LANDMINES AS A FORM OF COMMUNITY PROTECTION IN EASTERN MYANMAR

Gregory S. Cathcart

> "Some people want to remove landmines. Some want to keep [them] for security and protection." — Church leader, Tanintharyi[1]

Myanmar currently ranks third internationally in the number of accidents and deaths from landmines, after Afghanistan and Columbia.[2] While the use of landmines in Myanmar's myriad conflicts has been documented (Geneva Call 2011; Moser-Puangsuwan 2000a; Selth 2000a), the factors determining their inclusion as a form of community protection have been less researched (South 2012).

To better understand the role of landmine use in Myanmar, this chapter uses civilian self-protection frameworks put forward by South, Perhult, and Carstensen (2010) and Jose and Medie (2015) to outline how several historical and cultural factors, including a culture of militarization and the arbitrary role of patron-client relations, have together with the "four-cuts" counterinsurgent strategy created an environment of "chronic emergency"